

Critical Thinking –Journaling

1. Identify the biases that you are now able to relate to in your past experience. List the top three biases.

In my past work, I now realize I was running into a few biases without knowing it. One clear example is **confirmation bias**. Many times, while debugging, I would stick to the first idea that came to my mind. If I believed a certain module caused the issue, I would only look for things that supported that thought. Even when someone suggested checking something else, I would brush it aside. Later I understood this is exactly what the course calls my-side bias.

I also noticed **narrative bias** in the way I used to explain things to myself. If something went wrong, I quickly made up my own story like “this always breaks because of that part of the system.” It felt right in that moment, but I wasn’t checking facts — just going with a story that made sense to me.

The third bias I relate to is when **my emotions quietly affected my judgement**. For example, if I had a tough interaction with someone earlier, I sometimes became less open to their ideas later. It wasn’t about the idea itself — it was just my emotional reaction taking over without me noticing.

Now that I understand these biases, I’m more aware of how easily my thinking can get influenced, and I try to slow down and look at things more clearly and openly.

2. Did you catch yourself when you went through Fast (Non-Conscious) Thinking and Slow (Deliberate) Thinking? Share your experience.

Yes, I’ve seen moments where I switched between fast and slow thinking. One recent example was when my teammate reached out to me to help debug an issue. As soon as I heard the error, my mind immediately went to a similar problem we faced earlier. Without even checking properly, I said, “This is because of that same issue we had last time.” That was my **fast, automatic thinking** reacting purely based on past memory.

But when we started checking the logs together, things didn’t match what I had confidently assumed. That made me pause and look at the details instead of rushing. I shifted slowly, **deliberately thinking** and began tracing the flow step by step. After going deeper into the logs, we found the real root cause — and it had nothing to do with the issue I mentioned earlier.

That moment really showed me how fast thinking can make me jump to conclusions too quickly. Slowing down helped me avoid giving the wrong direction and solve the problem the right way.

3. Do you think eliminating emotions completely would be the right way to think critically? Share your experiences.

I don't think removing emotions completely is the right way to think critically. Emotions are always involved in how we see situations. For example, during a deployment issue, I was already frustrated from working the whole day. When someone asked if the failure was caused by my changes, I immediately got defensive without checking anything. Later, when I reviewed the logs calmly, I realized part of the issue was related to something I had missed.

That moment showed me how my emotional state pushed me to react too quickly. So, for me, it's not about removing emotions. It's about being aware of them. When I notice I'm stressed or irritated, I try to pause for a moment. That pause helps me think more clearly and respond more instead of reacting out of frustration.

4. Pick a problem or bug that you worked on few months back. Now with this new awareness, how would you define the problem statement better if the problem was given to you today? Which method helped you to define the problem statement better?

A few months ago, I was working on developing a Salesforce Experience Cloud site for my project. The requirement looked simply — show customer appointment details, a QR code for check-in, and a live weather widget. I started building everything assuming the data was coming from one source. My original problem statement was:

'Create an Experience site that shows appointment details with a QR code and weather info.'

Later, I realized the appointment data was not from a single system. Multiple upstream sources were involved, each with different formats. I also found challenges with the existing integration framework, which made the process more complex. That's when I understood my initial problem definition was incomplete.

If I had to define it today, I'd say:

‘Build an Experience Cloud site that pulls appointment data from multiple external systems, handles different data structures, generates QR codes from a separate service, and integrates real-time weather — all within current framework limitations.’

To refine this, I used slow thinking, breaking the problem down step-by-step and asking the right questions instead of assuming, and surfaced hidden dependencies before planning the solution. This helped me understand the real scope instead of just the UI part.